



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	9 March 2026	Time of Incident	9:40 AM
Directorate / Region	RMO – Goldfields-Esperance Region	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Procedure Breach	EQSafe Incident Number	57340
Actual Consequence	Insignificant	Potential Consequence	Major

Incident Short Description	Worker crossed the live lane onsite
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Executive Summary

On 9 March 2026, a worker was observed crossing the road in the live lane between traffic that was being escorted through site by the 'follow me' vehicle. The posted speed was 60 km/h, with the queued traffic moving at 40 km/h. The worker failed to contact traffic control and did not have a spotter when crossing in front of a single truck, which did not appear to have needed to brake or slow its speed. The worker crossed into the area where plant was operating within the traffic setup.

The Contractor was advised of the procedure breach and discussed the matter onsite with workers to prevent a repeat incident. The incident was also raised at the pre-start meeting on 18 March 2026 to reset expectations regarding interactions with live traffic.

Incident Photos



Photo of worker crossing live lane

Contributing Factors

- A spotter was not used and traffic control was not notified before the worker crossed the live lane.
- Worksite planning and layout were insufficient, resulting in congestion and limited parking for work vehicles.
- The hazard of worksite congestion was not adequately identified or managed during site set up.
- Congestion from multiple vehicles, combined with steep and wet shoulders, limited suitable parking options and led to the worker parking across the road.
- The hazard of workers crossing live lanes during medium and high impact works or congested worksites was not fully assessed or mitigated in the Project Risk Assessment.
- The SWMSs did not adequately address workers crossing the road.

Corrective Actions

- Ensure spotters are utilised when workers are required to cross roads and in high risk or congested worksite situations.
- Improve site planning and layout by providing adequate space for vehicles, plant and pedestrian movement, and by considering worksite congestion and environmental constraints (e.g., steep or wet shoulders). Extend worksite areas where required.
- Strengthen risk management by reviewing and updating the Project Risk Assessment to address workers crossing live lanes, worksite congestion in medium to high traffic areas, site layout, environmental conditions, and vehicle–pedestrian interactions. Ensure Contractor and Sub-Contractor SWMSs adequately address these risks.
- Reinforce compliance with safe vehicle operation by reminding all workers of the requirement to comply with Western Australian legislation and workplace procedures relating to mobile phone use while driving.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- During the investigation, it was identified that an individual observed the worker crossing the road and took a photo with their mobile phone while stationary as the second vehicle in the traffic control queue. This action constituted a distraction from driving duties and breached workplace procedures. All personnel must adhere to safety procedures at all times, as even well-intentioned actions can introduce additional risk and compromise site safety.



This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk profile relating to
Interaction with Live Traffic

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations